

Gabriel / Chosen

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CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 3 — Mary (Jordyn), Talia (Tasha), Shira(Tyfany), Adina(Jeovanie), Dafna(Ashley)

CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 2

Joseph has just exited.

JOSEPH

Tomorrow?

MARY

Tomorrow.

Joseph disappears.

Mary remains alone.

For several seconds, nothing happens.

Let the audience stay with her happiness.

Mary looks toward the place Joseph exited.

She smiles.

She begins quietly putting things in order.

Perhaps she

folds a piece of cloth;

straightens the unfinished table piece Joseph showed her;

moves one of the chairs;

touches the wood and imagines the future they were just discussing.

She catches herself smiling.

MARY

Eight chairs.

She shakes her head.

MARY

Joseph...

Small laugh.

She resumes folding.

THE INTERRUPTION

The distant sounds of Nazareth are still present.

A voice.

A cart.

A child somewhere outside.

A faint hammer.

Then—

everything stops.

Not slowly.

Gone.

Mary notices.

She waits.

MARY

Hello?

Nothing.

She listens.

MARY

Is someone there?

A subtle musical texture enters.

Something completely different from the musical language of Nazareth.

Not loud.

Not threatening.

Unfamiliar.

The light begins changing.

Mary turns.

She sees GABRIEL.

Gabriel does not rush toward her.

Stillness is part of the power of the moment.

GABRIEL

Mary.

Mary steps backward.

MARY

Who are you?

GABRIEL

Do not be afraid.

MARY

I wasn't—

She stops.

MARY

I... ok, wait...

Mary stops and backs away

Gabriel remains calm.

GABRIEL

You have found favor with God.

Gabriel walks towards Mary

MARY

Favor?

Still walks away from Gabriel slowly

GABRIEL

Yes.

Continues walking towards Mary

MARY

I don't understand.

Still walks backwards away from Gabriel

GABRIEL

You will.

Continues walking towards Mary

Beat.

MARY

Who are you?

Still walks backwards away from Gabriel

GABRIEL

Gabriel.

A beat.

Stops walking and stands still

GABRIEL

I have been sent by God.

Mary stops, she absorbs that.

She looks toward the doorway, as though part of her still expects someone else to walk in and make this ordinary again.

No one does.

THE CALLING

GABRIEL

Mary...

you have been chosen.

Mary looks at him.

MARY

Chosen for what?

GABRIEL

You will bear a son.

Silence.

Mary does not respond.

MARY

I'm sorry—

what did you say?

GABRIEL

You will bear a son.

MARY

No.

Not rejection.

Her mind simply cannot make the words fit.

MARY

I mean—

how?

Beat.

MARY

How can that be?

GABRIEL

What will happen comes from God.

MARY

I understand the words.

Beat.

MARY

I don't understand how they can be true.

GABRIEL

Nothing God has spoken is beyond His power.

Mary looks at him carefully.

MARY

Why me?

GABRIEL

Because God has chosen you.

MARY

That doesn't answer the question.

Gabriel regards her.

Not offended.

GABRIEL

It may be the only answer you are given tonight.

That lands.

MARY SEARCHES FOR CERTAINTY

MARY

You expect me to believe this?

GABRIEL

I expect you to decide whether you will trust the One who sent me.

MARY

Those aren't the same thing.

GABRIEL

No.

They are not.

Mary studies him.

That answer surprises her.

MARY

What happens now?

GABRIEL

You live the answer.

MARY

That's all?

GABRIEL

No.

Beat.

GABRIEL

Your relative Elizabeth is also expecting a child.

Mary looks up.

MARY

Elizabeth?

GABRIEL

Yes.

MARY

But she—

Mary stops herself.

She knows what she was going to say.

GABRIEL

What seemed impossible...

is already happening.

Mary takes that in.

This is the first piece of the message she can attach to something in her world.

MARY

Elizabeth.

GABRIEL

Go to her if you need to see what God has already begun.

THE COST ARRIVES

Mary looks toward the unfinished table.

The future from Scene 2 is sitting in front of her.

The house.

The table.

The marriage.

Joseph.

Her breathing changes slightly.

MARY

What will people think?

Gabriel does not answer immediately.

MARY

My family?

The village?

Still no false reassurance.

MARY

Joseph...

That name lands hardest.

MARY

What am I supposed to tell Joseph?

GABRIEL

The truth.

MARY

And if the truth sounds impossible?

GABRIEL

It will still be the truth.

MARY

That doesn't mean he'll believe me.

GABRIEL

No.

Mary looks at Gabriel.

That is not the answer she wanted.

MARY

You don't know Joseph.

GABRIEL

God does.

MARY

He has plans.

Her eyes move back to the table.

MARY

We have plans.

A home.

A wedding.

A family.

Beat.

MARY

He thinks he knows how our life is supposed to go.

GABRIEL

And you?

Mary looks at him.

MARY

Until a moment ago...

so did I.

MUSICAL TRIGGER — “CHOSEN”

The first musical phrase begins.

Not triumph.

Not celebration.

A question.

Gabriel does not suddenly disappear.

He remains present, but the focus begins transferring to Mary.

The song begins because she has finally understood

This miracle has a cost.

“CHOSEN”

SONG JOURNEY

SECTION 1 — WHY ME?

Mary confronts the word chosen.

She is not royalty.

Not powerful.

Not extraordinary by the world's standards.

Why would God place something this enormous in the hands of someone from Nazareth?

The lyrical thought should be

Why would being chosen feel this frightening?

SECTION 2 — WHAT WILL THIS COST?

Mary sees everything from Scene 2 in a new light

Joseph;

*their wedding;
the house;
the table;
her family;
her name;
what Nazareth will say;
whether Joseph will stay.*

*Fragments of the musical language of "My Beloved" may briefly appear underneath
"Chosen."*

Not a full reprise.

Just enough for the audience to feel the future that is now endangered.

SECTION 3 — I CANNOT SEE THE ROAD

Mary begins understanding that Gabriel is not going to give her the entire future.

She does not know

*what Joseph will do;
how people will react;
where this road ends;
what obedience will cost.*

The central realization

I do not have to see the whole road to take the next step.

SECTION 4 — CHOSEN BECOMES A CHOICE

The word changes meaning.

At the beginning of the song

God chose me.

By the end

Will I choose to trust God?

Possible central lyrical territory

Chosen doesn't mean unafraid.

and/or

If You chose me, give me courage to choose You.

The music grows emotionally—

but avoid turning it into a giant power-ballad finish.

This should feel like Mary becoming steady, not invincible.

THE MUSIC APPROACHES ITS FINAL RESOLUTION

Mary turns toward Gabriel.

The music holds.

Then—

nearly stops.

Silence.

Mary breathes.

She is still afraid.

That matters.

MARY

I don't understand what comes next.

GABRIEL

I know.

MARY

And I'm afraid.

GABRIEL

I know.

Beat.

MARY

But if God has asked this of me...

She gathers herself.

MARY

I am the Lord's servant.

Beat.

MARY

Let it be with me as He has said.

Silence.

No instant explosion of music.

No triumphant celebration.

Let the decision stand by itself.

Gabriel regards her.

For the first time, there may be something almost tender in his expression.

GABRIEL

Do not be afraid, Mary.

Mary takes a breath.

MARY

I'm trying.

GABRIEL

That is enough for tonight.

GABRIEL DEPARTS

The light around Gabriel begins to change.

Do not make his departure a magic trick simply for spectacle.

It can be

a controlled fade;

a shift in light;

Gabriel moving into darkness;

Mary's attention being pulled briefly elsewhere and finding him gone.

The divine musical texture recedes.

Mary is alone again.

Same room.

Same wood.

Same cloth.

Same unfinished table.

Nothing looks different.

Everything is different.

FINAL MOMENT

Mary stands quietly.

She touches the unfinished table.

A faint fragment of "My Beloved" is heard.

Perhaps only a few notes.

Mary remembers

"Whatever comes, I'll walk with you."

Her expression changes.

Not because she regrets saying yes.

Because now she understands what she has to do next.

She looks toward the direction Joseph left.

MARY

Joseph...

Blackout or controlled transition.

END SCENE 3